

CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **September 17, 2026** — a light daily touch against the last delivered cycle (2026-09-15_draft, committed).

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED (light daily touch, score set 2026-09-17_draft). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk and Tokenization RWA were re-checked and held flat. **Fed & Macro RE-RATED DOWN** (34/33/44/54/60 → 32/30/38/44/58) — and the reason is not the one in the headlines. The September FOMC hiked 25bp to **3¾–4%** on a **12–0** vote (federalreserve.gov, primary), but this system had carried a hike as its base case since Warsh's August 28 Jackson Hole speech, so scoring it again would be charging twice for the same fact. What was genuinely new is in the projections released alongside: the median federal funds rate for **end-2027 moved from 3.6% to 4.1%** — a full year of expected easing deleted — with 12 of 18 participants also penciling one further hike this year. August retail sales the same morning (+1.2% m/m, control group +1.4% vs ~0.8% consensus, Census primary) confirmed it. The counterweight is real and is sized in: Chair Warsh filed *no dot at all* and said "I'm not in the forward guidance business." So the cut is shaped — only –2 points of P at one month, but –10 at one year, the window the "cuts resume" assumption actually lived in. Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — auto-stamped per the runbook's delegated authority, which since 2026-09-02 explicitly does not let the size of a move or a call-band flip withhold the stamp. **One item needs Alex:** yesterday's score set (2026-09-16_draft) was written but never stamped or committed — see Status & honesty notes.

THE FINAL NUMBER · SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 (COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED, LIGHT DAILY TOUCH) · BTC \$76,440.74 ON SEPT 17

–0.11 Neutral — but below zero for the first time in this run, down from +0.45 at the last delivered cycle

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale –10 to +10). The headline reads –0.11 equal-weight; the horizon-weighted variant reads **+0.43**, versus +0.97 at the last delivered cycle, which flips *that* variant from Mild Bull to Neutral. The headline stays Neutral, but it has crossed below zero and **two window calls flipped**: 3 months went Mild Bear → Bear and 1 year went Bull → Mild Bull. The whole move is one pillar — Fed & Macro, on the FOMC's *projections* rather than its rate decision. For the record, yesterday's never-delivered set would have read +0.01 on today's quant data, so about a tenth of the fall is the CLARITY cloture failure catching up in the published lineage and the rest is the Fed.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	-1.94	Bear — the worst window, deepening from -1.41 at the last delivered cycle. CLARITY (-3.81) after the failed cloture vote and Fed (-2.45) now sit alongside Iran’s -4.70; Bitcoin TA (+0.96) and Tokenization (+0.29) are the only positives
3 months	-1.74	Bear — a call flip down from Mild Bear. Fed takes this one to -2.72: both remaining 2026 FOMC meetings sit inside this window, and the Committee’s own median now expects a further hike at one of them
6 months	-0.76	Mild Bear — Fed -0.77→-1.54 as the projections hold 4.1% straight through 2027, removing the pause-then-pivot this window was carrying
1 year	+1.15	Mild Bull — a call flip down from Bull. Fed crosses negative here (+0.48→-0.72), which is what deleting a year of expected easing does. Tokenization (+3.00), CLARITY (+2.88) and Bitcoin TA (+1.82) still carry it
3 years	+2.76	Bull — barely moved, and still every pillar positive. Deferring an easing cycle by a year does not reach three years out

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The leave-one-out range this cycle is -0.67 to +0.51 — the headline still **changes sign** depending on which single pillar you drop: dropping Iran alone lifts it to +0.67 (Mild Bull), dropping Tokenization alone pushes it to -0.52 (Mild Bear), and dropping CLARITY now leaves it at -0.00 — this pillar has landed almost exactly on the average. See the Master Report’s Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf	The summary. The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf	The math pillar. 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs	The story pillars. CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → Aug 22 committed → Aug 28/29 drafts → Aug 31 committed → Sept 1 committed → Sept 2 committed → Sept 5 committed → Sept 6 committed → Sept 8 committed → Sept 9 committed → Sept 10 committed → Sept 11 committed → Sept 12 committed, auto-stamped, light daily → Sept 12 draft2, the full weekly refresh, draft, awaiting Alex's review → Sept 13, 14, 15 committed, auto-stamped, light daily → Sept 16, this light daily touch, committed, auto-stamped).
4	reports/archive/ + prior-work/	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with <code>run.py blend --set NAME</code>), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal** = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$ (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (September 17 P's — light daily touch, Fed & Macro re-rated DOWN; COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	22	30	38	70	88	Held flat at the level it re-rated to after Senate cloture on the motion to proceed to H.R. 3633 FAILED 49–50 on Sept 15 (senate.gov, primary) — zero Democratic yes votes, four Republican no votes, and sponsor Lummis saying “I think we’re done. It’s over.” The Tillis motion to reconsider is still pending and unacted-on; today’s only fresh item was post-mortem politics, which moves nothing
Iran War Risk	1	1	18	38	70	Held flat through a genuine piece of news: the damaged Saudi East–West pipeline is being restored (“measured in days,” U.S. Energy Secretary, Sept 15) and Brent fell from ~\$108 to ~\$103. That relieves an oil squeeze; it is not a de-escalation. Hormuz is still closed, Iran still refuses to reopen it absent U.S. concessions, and the Salalah ministerial still has no date
Tokenization (RWA)	52	60	66	74	85	Held flat for a fifteenth cycle: rwa.xyz unchanged at \$38.86B (Sept 15 read, +1.00% 30d, ~4.24M holders); no rail failure, depeg or counterparty default; DTCC’s October full-service launch on schedule. Now the only pillar positive on every window — and the one carrying the blend’s upside
Fed & Macro	32	30	38	44	58	RE-RATED DOWN — the FOMC hiked 12–0 to 3¾–4% (already priced), but its projections moved the 2027 median fed funds rate from 3.6% to 4.1% , deleting a year of expected easing (not priced). Cut shaped to that: –2 at 1mo, –10 at 12mo, which flips this pillar negative at one year. Counterweight sized in: Warsh filed no dot and disavows forward guidance
Bitcoin TA (quant)	58	54	59	69	69	Recomputed on a local quant refresh (BTC \$76,440.74, Sept 17). Near term eased (1mo 61→58) as the weekly composite slipped to +30.4 as-is (+31.3 on completed bars); the long end firmed (1yr 68→69) as the cycle clock reached month 28.94. Notable: the tape absorbed both a dead bill and a hawkish Fed without leaving its range

P values shown (50 = coin flip). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk and Tokenization held flat this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down, and this set (light daily touch, 2026-09-17_draft) is COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED. Yesterday’s set (2026-09-16_draft) carried the CLARITY re-rate but was never stamped or committed — it remains status draft and is flagged for Alex below; this run left it untouched, as the runbook requires, and carries its numbers forward here instead.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status:** the September 17 light daily score set (2026-09-17_draft) builds on the last delivered cycle (2026-09-15_draft, committed). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk and Tokenization RWA were re-checked and held flat. **Fed & Macro re-rated DOWN**, 34/33/44/54/60 → 32/30/38/44/58. **AUTO-STAMPED** per the runbook's delegated daily authority.
- **Needs Alex — a pipeline matter, not a research one.** The score set 2026-09-16_draft, which carries the CLARITY Act re-rate after Tuesday's failed cloture vote, is still status: draft with stamped_by null and was never committed to git — even though its own note text says it was auto-stamped. That run appears to have stopped between writing the scores and stamping them, and it left the reports half-updated; this cycle repaired the reports. Today's run did *not* edit that set, because the runbook permits in-place amendment only of today's own undelivered set and lineage is sacred. Its numbers are carried forward into today's committed set, and every score table shows it honestly as an unstamped draft. Your call whether to stamp it retroactively.
- **Verification:** this cycle's load-bearing facts are about as well sourced as this system gets — both are Federal Reserve primary documents, **fetched directly** rather than read through an intermediary: the FOMC statement of Sept 16 (25bp to 3¾–4%, 12–0, no dissents) and the Summary of Economic Projections, Table 1 (median fed funds 4.1% for 2026 and 4.1% for 2027, up from June's 3.6%). The August retail-sales print is Census primary. Five-plus independent outlets (CNBC, Wolf Street, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, Bondsavvy) report the same medians and the same 2027 revision. Where an outlet returned HTTP 403, the same facts were taken from alternatives and cross-checked against the primary documents rather than relied on alone. Market prices — the 10-year back at 5.0%, the equity slide, BTC's level through the press conference — are reported and explicitly *not* used to move any P.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles; the TA pillar caps its own conviction at $P = 50 \pm 25$; single-source items are labeled in-line; current chart bars are partial and the completed-bar numbers are printed alongside; and the leave-one-out range this cycle (–0.67 to +0.51) genuinely crosses zero — dropping Iran alone gives +0.51 (Mild Bull), dropping Tokenization alone gives –0.52 (Mild Bear). Read the headline +0.02 as “the forces cancel,” not as a forecast of flatness.
- **What the calendar does next:** the two remaining 2026 FOMC meetings, at which the Committee's own median expects **one further 25bp hike** — delivered, this re-rate is confirmed and the 6-month and 1-year windows go lower; skipped, the dots overstated the commitment and Fed & Macro re-rates back up. Then: whether the Tillis motion to reconsider on CLARITY is ever actually called, and the **October DTCC full-service tokenization launch**, which is the next real test of the pillar currently holding up the whole blend.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check the CLARITY Act pillar's trigger table and flip line — the flip line was written down *before* the vote, it says exactly what to do if cloture failed, and this is the cycle where it fired. You can judge the re-rate against a rule that was published in advance rather than against a story written afterwards.